

and installation into Continuous Integration and Continuous Deployment process.

Bonus—Why are we doing things in production on Friday nights?

Answer: Because no one says we can't and it was a convenient time for the developer to prepare for a deployment we'd be doing on Monday.

Proportional investment: Tony—Make an announcement to the team. There will be no production changes on Friday, Saturday, or Sunday unless an exception has been made and approved by David (VP Engineering). We will reevaluate this policy when we have a fully automated continuous deployment process in place.

As a result of this Five Whys session and the proportional investments we made, our deployments are easier, quicker, and never again will our process allow a developer to place gems into production systems with unintended consequences. Indeed, we have not had another issue like this. We strengthened our “cluster immune system” as you would say.

Without the Five Whys, we would have never discovered all of the information we did here. My guess is that we would have told that one developer to not do stupid things on Friday nights and moved on. This is what I emphasized earlier, where a good Five Whys session has two outputs, learning and doing. The proportional investments that came out of this session are obviously valuable, but the learnings are much more subtle, but amazing for growing as developers and as a team.